

Sacred Kompass Theme Audit

Static codebase review of the supplied WordPress theme archive (fixed_v19).

Scope	53 PHP files, 26 CSS files, 28 JS files, 15 fonts
Approx. size	23,159 lines across PHP/CSS/JS
Audit mode	Static architecture, template, content mapping, fallback, SEO, caching, and mobile typography review
Primary source	Uploaded archive: fixed_v19 (2).zip

Overall verdict: the theme has a solid CPT-based foundation, but it is **not yet fully system-driven**. Several pages still rely on hardcoded copy, hardcoded fallbacks, missing bundled fallback assets, duplicated story templates, overly broad SEO defaults, and very small mobile typography.

The most urgent problems are: (1) missing fallback image/video assets and one missing production JS file, (2) stale 12-hour art gallery caching, (3) story/archive pages that bypass the content system with hardcoded marketing copy, and (4) SEO rules that incorrectly index search and 404 pages.

What is working well

- The theme is modularized cleanly across **inc/**, **template-parts/**, and CPT modules.
- Core content entities already exist as CPTs/options: art, story, team, FAQ, events, legal, announcements, and navigation items.
- Most frontend output uses WordPress escaping helpers, which lowers immediate XSS risk in templates reviewed.
- Section Manager and CPT architecture show the right long-term direction for system-managed content.

Critical findings

P0 — Broken fallback assets are referenced throughout the codebase

- The theme references multiple bundled fallback files that do not exist in the supplied archive. There is **no assets/images directory**, yet runtime code points to **assets/images/logo.png**, **about-brand-bg.jpg**, **offerings-bg.jpg**, **pillar-1..5.jpg**, and **hero-bg-video.mp4**.
- This means several fallback states are not safe: broken image requests, broken OG image fallback, broken seeded art images, and broken decorative backgrounds are all possible.
- **Evidence:** inc/helpers.php:135, 140, 161, 243-286; inc/content.php:62; inc/seo.php:72; template-parts/home/about.php:19-31; template-parts/home/stories-preview.php:12-14.
- **Fix:** either ship these assets, or remove all file-based fallbacks and replace them with admin-required media fields plus safe empty states.

P0 — Production JS mismatch: art-showcase.min.js is enqueued but missing

- The production path resolves to **/assets/js/art-showcase.min.js** unless **SCRIPT_DEBUG** is enabled, but only **art-showcase.js** exists in the archive.
- That creates a guaranteed frontend 404 on homepage and art gallery pages in production mode.
- **Evidence:** inc/setup.php:224-230; assets/js/art-showcase.js exists; assets/js/art-showcase.min.js missing.
- **Fix:** build and commit the minified file, or enqueue the existing unminified file until a build step is formalized.

P0 — Art card image publication delay is very likely caused by 12-hour transient caching

- Both the homepage art section and the art gallery page cache the complete art card payload in a shared transient called **sk_art_data** for **12 hours**.

- Invalidation only happens on **save_post_sk_art**. If the image changes through attachment replacement, thumbnail/meta changes, media regeneration, or another path that does not execute the same save flow, stale image URLs can remain public for hours.
- This matches the reported symptom: card content appears, but the updated image takes a long time to become public.
- **Evidence:** page-art.php:10-55; template-parts/home/art.php:14-59; inc/cpt-art.php:160-188; inc/setup.php:367-372.
- **Fix:** centralize art query/caching in one helper, reduce TTL sharply (or disable until stable), and invalidate on **save_post_sk_art**, **set_post_thumbnail**, **added/updated/deleted_post_meta** for **art_image_id** and **_thumbnail_id**, and attachment edit/replace events.

P0 — Not all content strings are mapped to options/CPTs; major story surfaces are still hardcoded

- The stories page and story archive contain hardcoded hero title, hero subtitle, badge labels, CTA heading, CTA body, CTA button text, no-results strings, and read-link labels.
- This directly violates the requirement that content strings should be system-managed instead of hardcoded in templates.
- **Evidence:** page-stories.php:86-99, 115-116, 182, 192, 209-220; archive-sk_story.php:94-107, 125-127, 181, 189, 206-217.
- **Fix:** move all marketing copy for stories into options or a dedicated stories page settings group, and use a single renderer shared by both the page template and the CPT archive.

P0 — SEO defaults are too broad and can index the wrong pages

- The fallback SEO block applies **index**, **follow** globally, including pages that should usually be noindex such as **search** and **404** results.
- The SEO logic only has custom branches for home and the art page. Most other pages fall back to generic site-level description text, which weakens relevance and can create duplicated metadata.
- Structured data exists only for the homepage (ProfessionalService) and blog posts (BlogPosting). Stories, art singles, collective, legal, event archive, and custom pages have no dedicated schema.
- **Evidence:** inc/seo.php:64-131, 140-179; 404.php; search.php.
- **Fix:** add explicit branches for search/noindex, 404/noindex, story archive, story single, art single, collective, legal pages, and events; generate per-template title/description/canonical/OG/schema.

High-priority structural findings

- **Static fallback navigation still exists in three places:** header.php:83-97, footer.php:35-57, inc/cpt-nav.php:139-149. If the CPT is empty, the site silently serves a hardcoded nav instead of failing loudly or prompting required setup.
- **Story template duplication:** page-stories.php and archive-sk_story.php implement nearly the same UI separately. This increases regression risk and guarantees content drift over time.
- **Hardcoded contact paths** remain scattered through the theme: header.php:86, 183; footer.php:46; template-parts/home/faq.php:31; single-sk_art.php:32; archive-sk_event.php:178; page-stories.php:214; inc/seo.php:154; plus several defaults in inc/helpers.php and admin field defaults.
- **Theme activation and first-run logic mutates content/options:** functions.php:45-60 forces a specific story preview subtitle and flushes rewrites. This is deployment-side behavior, not content management.
- **Seed content is still business copy, not neutral scaffolding:** inc/content.php inserts demo art, founder bios, FAQs, and legal copy. Good for demos, risky for production because it mixes placeholder content with live editorial systems.
- **About section still has hardcoded brand/domain behavior:** template-parts/home/about.php auto-links sacredkompass.org in welcome text and uses missing fallback background assets despite comment claiming no fallback strings.

Mobile typography audit

The complaint about text being too small on mobile is supported by the CSS. The theme contains many sub-1rem sizes for real UI and content, not just decorative labels.

File	Example	Why it matters
assets/css/typography.css	.eyebrow = 0.63rem desktop / 0.72rem mobile	Section labels become tiny on phones
assets/css/navigation.css	0.5rem, 0.55rem, 0.74rem, 0.75rem	Navigation becomes visually compressed and harder to tap/read
assets/css/stories-archive.css	0.55rem, 0.57rem, 0.62rem, 0.72rem	Story metadata and support text are undersized
assets/css/home-cta.css	labels/buttons around 0.58rem–0.72rem	Form labels and CTA microcopy feel too small
assets/css/home-philosophy.css	.ct-quote 0.92rem on mobile override	Editorial quote blocks feel lighter than intended

● **Recommendation:** set a minimum readable mobile content size of **1rem** for body copy and **0.875rem** for supporting labels, then rebuild all clamps from that floor upward.

● **Recommendation:** separate decorative micro-label tokens from real content tokens so editorial text never inherits ultra-small UI sizing.

Dynamic mapping scorecard

The system architecture is mixed. Some modules are properly dynamic; several important pages are only partially dynamic.

Area	Status	Notes
Art data	Mostly dynamic	Uses sk_art CPT, but still falls back to placeholder card and shared transient cache
FAQ data	Mostly dynamic	FAQ items come from sk_faq CPT; CTA URL still hardcoded to /#contact
Collective members	Mostly dynamic	Team data comes from sk_team CPT; empty-state copy and some CTA text remain hardcoded
Navigation	Partially dynamic	sk_nav CPT exists, but header/footer/CPT layer all contain hardcoded fallback menus
Stories listing	Partially dynamic	Story posts are dynamic, but surrounding marketing copy/CTA/badges are hardcoded in templates
Legal pages	Partially dynamic	Rendered from sk_legal, but seeded legal copy and page creation are hardcoded in activation
SEO metadata	Partially dynamic	Home and art page have special handling; most other routes do not

Recommended remediation roadmap

Phase 1 — Stabilize production quickly (same day)

- Add or remove all missing fallback assets. The current state is worse than having no fallback because the fallback itself 404s.
- Fix the art-showcase production enqueue mismatch.
- Reduce or remove the 12-hour art transient immediately; add invalidation hooks for image changes.
- Set search and 404 pages to noindex in the fallback SEO block.

Phase 2 — Remove hardcoded presentation copy (1–3 days)

- Create a stories settings group for hero title, subtitle, badge labels, CTA heading/body/button, no-results text, and read-link labels.
- Refactor page-stories.php and archive-sk_story.php to use one shared partial and one shared data source.
- Move hardcoded footer/header fallback nav labels into required admin seeding or remove the fallback entirely.

Phase 3 — System integrity and SEO hardening (3–7 days)

- Create per-template SEO resolvers for collective, stories, art singles, legal, search, 404, and events.
- Add schema types relevant to each surface (CollectionPage, Article/Review-like story schema if appropriate, Organization/AboutPage, ContactPage, Event).

- Separate demo seed content from production setup so activation does not inject marketing/legal copy into live installs unless explicitly requested.
- Introduce a build step or CI check that verifies every enqueued asset exists before deployment.

Dead code / legacy / override candidates

- **Duplicate story implementations** are the clearest maintenance deadweight: page-stories.php and archive-sk_story.php should not both own the same UI.
- **register_nav_menus()** exists in inc/setup.php:13, but the frontend navigation is driven by sk_nav CPT instead of WordPress menus. If WP menus are no longer used, this is legacy surface area.
- **File-based asset fallbacks in helpers** are effectively dead because the referenced files are not present in the archive.
- **Comments are outdated in a few places**, for example the privacy template mentions hardcoded fallback content, but the legal flow is now CPT/seed driven. That makes maintenance harder because comments no longer reflect runtime truth.

Final conclusion

This codebase is **close to a strong system-driven WordPress theme**, but it is not there yet. The content model is promising; the implementation still leaks too many hardcoded defaults, placeholder fallbacks, and duplicated page templates. The fastest path to improvement is to: **(1)** eliminate broken asset fallbacks, **(2)** fix art cache invalidation, **(3)** unify story templates, and **(4)** expand template-aware SEO.

If those four items are handled first, the theme will become much more predictable, easier to publish from admin, and materially better on both mobile UX and search indexing quality.

Key evidence references

Art cache: page-art.php:10-55; template-parts/home/art.php:14-59; inc/cpt-art.php:160-188; inc/setup.php:367-372

Missing asset fallbacks: inc/helpers.php:135, 140, 161, 243-286; inc/content.php:62; inc/seo.php:72; template-parts/home/about.php:19-31; template-parts/home/stories-preview.php:12-14

Stories hardcoded copy: page-stories.php:86-99, 182, 209-220; archive-sk_story.php:94-107, 181, 206-217

Fallback nav: header.php:83-97; footer.php:35-57; inc/cpt-nav.php:139-149

SEO gaps: inc/seo.php:64-131, 140-179

Mobile small type: assets/css/typography.css:2, 57-60; assets/css/navigation.css:99, 123, 366; assets/css/stories-archive.css:717; assets/css/home-cta.css:236, 279; assets/css/home-philosophy.css:181

First-run mutation: functions.php:45-60

Missing production JS: inc/setup.php:224-230 with assets/js/art-showcase.min.js absent